Week 2 | Real-book guide

October 19 to 23 | A difficult problem changes when everyone works together.

One book, all subjects

Big Pumpkin | A difficult problem changes when everyone works together. Math: Share pumpkin counters or seeds into equal groups and represent the groups with the week's operation. Science: Use a toy pumpkin or car to show how a push or pull changes position and motion. Social studies: Match each character to a team role and explain how cooperation helps the group. Finish: Create a lift-the-pumpkin paper chain showing each helper in order.

Grade 3 | Big Pumpkin

Erica Silverman | Picture-book story

Prepare

one copy of Big Pumpkin; scene props or picture choices matched to the selected page; response frame; finished basket Use selected scenes from Big Pumpkin to teach both learners. Their TEKS targets are individual; the read-aloud, page evidence and shared discussion are shared.

2026-10-19: Answer who and where questions; identify the first event with a picture or page clue. (TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D)

2026-10-20: Answer what happened next and place that event in the sequence. (TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D)

2026-10-21: Retell the beginning, middle and end with three visual event cards. (TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D)

2026-10-22: Answer a why or how question with a picture, AAC response or page detail. (TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D)

2026-10-23: Retell the event sequence and answer three new story WH questions. (TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D)

Teach from the actual pages

Read a short section aloud. Think aloud and point to evidence (I Do). Act or sequence it together, then return to the page (We Do). Ask a fresh question and collect the planned response (You Do).

Grade 4 | Big Pumpkin

Erica Silverman | Picture-book story

Prepare

one copy of Big Pumpkin; scene props or picture choices matched to the selected page; response frame; finished basket Use selected scenes from Big Pumpkin to teach both learners. Their TEKS targets are individual; the read-aloud, page evidence and shared discussion are shared.

2026-10-19: Find the story problem and explain a character's first action with an illustration. (TEKS 4.8C, 4.7C)

2026-10-20: Sequence a character's action and explain what changes next. (TEKS 4.8C, 4.7C)

2026-10-21: Explain the beginning, middle and end, including how a character responds. (TEKS 4.8C, 4.7C)

2026-10-22: Explain why a character acts and show a page clue for the result. (TEKS 4.8C, 4.7C)

2026-10-23: Explain the problem and solution; support one answer with page evidence. (TEKS 4.8C, 4.7C)

Teach from the actual pages

Read a short section aloud. Think aloud and point to evidence (I Do). Act or sequence it together, then return to the page (We Do). Ask a fresh question and collect the planned response (You Do).

Book access

Borrow a physical book or authorized library/publisher edition. These guides contain teaching prompts, not reproductions of the books. HMH supplies the grade-level reading, writing, drama and spelling selections.